PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Swedish & Relaxation Massage

Times in [brackets] suit a 60-minute session. Check your state board rules.

SCREEN

Intake and health check reviewed. No fever, clot signs, acute injury or open skin.

CHECK-IN

Ask about goals, pressure (1–5), focus areas, areas to avoid and any changes since last visit.

PRE-SESSION

Ask about nut, oil and scent allergies. Confirm consent for any sensitive areas.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Fresh linens & cover ☐ Table disinfected ☐ Room warm ☐ Oils in pumps ☐ Nut-free oil ☐ Bolsters ☐ Hands washed

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Intake review**	3 min	Review intake and health check. Defer or refer if anything is a red flag.
2	**Consent & draping**	2 min	Explain the flow and draping. Client may stop or change pressure any time.
3	**Privacy to undress**	3 min	Step out. Client undresses to comfort level and lies under the top sheet.
4	**Positioning**	2 min	Knock first. Prone or supine; bolster ankles or knees, adjust cradle.
5	**Warming strokes**	5 min	Broad effleurage with the chosen oil to warm tissue and settle breathing.
6	**Main work by region**	35 min	Back and shoulders, legs, arms, neck: petrissage, friction, gentle stretch.
7	**Pressure check-ins**	ongoing	Ask early and at each new area. Adjust for wincing or held breath.
8	**Endangerment sites**	ongoing	Light or no pressure on front of neck, back of knee, armpit, inner elbow.
9	**Finishing strokes**	3 min	Slow effleurage, then still hands. Tell the client the session has ended.
10	**Privacy to dress**	3 min	Step out. Invite the client to sit up slowly and take their time.
11	**Notes & water**	5 min	Offer water, review aftercare card, write SOAP notes, rebook.

ENDPOINT AND SAFETY

- Genitals and gluteal cleft always draped
- Pressure matched to feedback, never past comfort
- Uncover only the area being worked
- Skip rashes, wounds, varicose veins, new tattoos

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Dizzy or faint: sit slowly, or lie back with legs up. Water and rest.
- Skin reaction: remove the product, wash with mild soap, switch to nut-free.
- Client uneasy with draping: pause, re-drape and ask what they need.
- Sharp pain, numbness or tingling: stop and reposition. Avoid the area.
- Clot signs (one calf swollen, red, warm, sore): stop, refer urgently.
- Chest pain, trouble breathing or stroke signs: call 911 right away.

Always write an incident report and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Length · focus	Pressure (1–5)	Oil or lotion used	Add-ons · scent
Areas avoided	**Client response**	**Therapist notes**	**Next visit · initials**